

TrueCrypt can create a virtual disk on your computer that will look and feel just like a normal disk on your computer. The “drive” will actually be a file stored on your computer, but it

is completely encrypted and secure, so that when you turn off your computer, the data can’t be recovered unless you know the correct password. Of course, losing this password means losing your data, so don’t forget it under circumstance. It even encrypts the file names and the folder names on the volume. TrueCrypt supports Windows Vista and Windows XP x64. It also runs on Linux and you can open a TrueCrypt volume on any of these platforms.

Once installed, click on Create Volume. Choose Create a Standard TruCrypt Volume. Click Select File, browse to where you want the file stored and type in a name for the file. Next choose the encryption that you want. The default option is the lowest encryption method, AES and the last in the drop down being the highest. Remember, each time something is read from the virtual disk, it has to be decrypted and it will take more time to decrypt if the encryption is stronger.

Next choose the size for your virtual drive. Click Next and now type in a strong password. It is essential you type in a long and complex password so that it cannot be easily cracked. As such, the program asks for a minimum of 20 characters. On the next screen, a random header and master key will be



Encrypting a drive's contents



An encrypted drive